What Matters to Us

A parent + student worksheet to agree on what you are looking for before you search

Curtis College Prep

Fill this out separately first, with no peeking. Then compare. Mark one box per row for each person: Must have (I would not go without it), Nice to have, or Skip (I don't care). Rows where you disagree are the best things to talk about.

Student name: _____ Parent / guardian: _____

	STUDENT			PARENT / GUARDIAN			DIFFER?
WHAT WE ARE LOOKING FOR	**Must**	**Nice**	**Skip**	**Must**	**Nice**	**Skip**	**talk!**
Cost and financial aid What we can really pay per year	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Distance from home How far is OK? Can we afford trips home?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
School size Small, medium or large classes and campus	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Majors and programs The subjects I might study	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Campus setting City, suburb, small town or rural	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Belonging and community Students, culture and groups like me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Academic support Advising, tutoring, first-gen programs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Jobs after graduation Graduation rate, career help, earnings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Research and honors Challenge, internships, special programs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Activities and sports Clubs, teams, arts, things I love	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Housing and food Dorm options, meal plans, living costs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Faith or cultural life Worship, traditions, identity centers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other: _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other: _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Check the DIFFER? box for every row where your answers do not match. Those go on page 2.

1. Our top 5, in order

Look at your Must rows. Together, pick the five that matter most and rank them. These become the filters you use on the Curtis College Prep search page.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

2. Our real limits

Most we can pay per year: _____ **Money we have saved:** _____

Grants / scholarships expected: _____ **Loans we are comfortable with:** _____

Farthest from home (miles or hours): _____ **Deal breakers:** _____

> **Use net price, not sticker price**
> The price on a school's website is rarely what a family pays. Most schools must offer a free net price calculator. Our school profiles link to it and show typical net price by income bracket. Many schools also give application-fee waivers if you ask; cost should never stop you from applying.

3. Where we disagree (the DIFFER? rows)

Topic: _____ **Student wants:** _____ **Parent wants:** _____

Topic: _____ **Student wants:** _____ **Parent wants:** _____

Topic: _____ **Student wants:** _____ **Parent wants:** _____

Ways to talk it through: What is the worry behind that answer? What would have to be true for us both to feel OK? Which one can we test with a campus visit?

4. Next steps

- [ ] Search schools on curtiscollege.com using our top 5
- [ ] Save 8 to 12 schools to our tracker (a mix of reach, target and safety)
- [ ] Print a Campus Visit Scorecard for each school we visit or tour online
- [ ] Fill in the College Comparison Grid for our top 4